organ. Sex is biological needs of the youth. After this, human being moves to safety needs. After one's stomach is full, she/ he needs a safe environment. Cloth and shelter provide security from the general environmental torments and the foes.

- **Additional needs:** The secondary human needs, associated with career development and better living standard, are termed as additional needs. He needs love, care, affection, respect, freedom and eventually self fulfillment.

4.7 Marriage

Introduction



Marriage is one of the most ancient, important, universal and indispensable social relationship which has been in existence since the inception of human civilization.

Definition of Marriage

1. According to Encyclopedia Britannica, "Marriage is a physical, legal and moral union between man and woman in complete community life for the establishment of a family."
2. According to Malinowski, "Marriage is a contract for the production and maintenance of children."

Characteristics of Marriage

1. Marriage is a permanent bond between husband and wife. It is designed to fulfill the social, psychological, biological and religious aims.
2. Marriage is a specific relationship between two individuals of opposite sex and based on mutual rights and obligations. Relationship is enduring.
3. Marriage requires social approval. The relationship between men and women must have social approval without which marriage is not valid.
4. Marriage establishes family. Family helps in providing facilities for the procreation and upbringing of children.
5. Marriage creates mutual obligations between husband and wife. The couple fulfills their mutual obligations on the basis of customs or rules.
6. Marriage is always associated with some civil and religious ceremony. This social and religious ceremony provides validity to marriage. Though modern marriage performed in courts still it requires certain religious or customary practices.
7. Marriage regulates sex relationship according to prescribed customs and laws.
8. Marriage has certain symbols like ring, vermillion, special cloths, special sign before the house etc.

DO YOU KNOW?

Prohibition of Child Marriage Act states that a girl in India should not marry before the age of 18, and a boy before 21.

Functions of marriage

1. Regulation of sex life and inheritance or procreation
2. Marriage leads establishment of family
3. Provides economic cooperation
4. Marriage contributes to emotional and intellectual interstimulation of the partners
5. Marriage aims at social solidarity

Social Benefits Of Marriage

Marriage and Health

- On average, husbands and wives are healthier, happier and enjoy longer lives than those who are not married.

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